

Table of contents



Search this book



AA

Preface

▼ 1 Introduction to Psychology

Introduction

1.1 What Is Psychology?

1.2 History of Psychology

1.3 Contemporary Psychology

1.4 Careers in Psychology

Key Terms

Summary

Review Questions

Critical Thinking Questions

Personal Application Questions

▶ 2 Psychological Research

▶ 3 Biopsychology

▶ 4 States of Consciousness

▶ 5 Sensation and Perception

▶ 6 Learning

▶ 7 Thinking and Intelligence

▶ 8 Memory

▶ 9 Lifespan Development

▶ 10 Emotion and Motivation

▶ 11 Personality

▶ 12 Social Psychology

▶ 13 Industrial-Organizational Psychology

Welcome to *Psychology 2e*, an OpenStax resource. This textbook was written to increase student access to high-quality learning materials, maintaining highest standards of academic rigor at little to no cost.

About OpenStax

OpenStax is part of Rice University, which is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit charitable corporation. Our mission is to make an amazing education accessible for all. Through our partnerships with philanthropic organizations and our alliance with other educational resource companies, we're breaking down the most common barriers to learning. Because we believe that everyone should and can have access to knowledge.

About OpenStax Resources

Customization

Psychology 2e is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 (CC BY NC-SA) license, which means that you can non-commercially distribute, remix, and build upon the content, as long as you provide attribution to OpenStax and its content contributors, and distribute all derivatives under the same license.

Because our books are openly licensed, you are free to use the entire book or pick and choose the sections that are most relevant to the needs of your course. Feel free to remix the content by assigning your students certain chapters and sections in your syllabus, in the order that you prefer. You can even provide a direct link in your syllabus to the sections in the web view of your book.

Instructors also have the option of creating a customized version of their OpenStax book. The custom version can be made available to students in low-cost print or digital form through their campus bookstore. Visit the Instructor Resources section of your book page on openstax.org for more information.

Art Attribution in *Psychology 2e*

In *Psychology 2e*, most art contains attribution to its title, creator or rights holder, host platform, and license within the caption. For any art that is openly licensed, non-commercial users or organizations may reuse the art as long as they provide the same attribution to its original source. (Commercial entities should contact OpenStax to discuss reuse rights and permissions.) To maximize readability and content flow, some art does not include attribution in the text. If you reuse art from this text that does not have attribution provided, use the following attribution: Copyright Rice University, OpenStax, under CC BY NC-SA 4.0 license.

Errata

All OpenStax textbooks undergo a rigorous review process. However, like any professional-grade textbook, errors sometimes occur. Since our books are web based, we can make updates periodically when deemed pedagogically necessary. If you have a correction to suggest, submit it through the link on your book page on openstax.org. Subject matter experts review all errata suggestions. OpenStax is committed to remaining transparent about all updates, so you will also find a list of past errata changes on your book page on openstax.org.

Format

You can access this textbook for free in web view or PDF through openstax.org, and for a low cost in print.

About *Psychology 2e*

Psychology 2e is designed to meet scope and sequence requirements for the single-semester introduction to psychology course. The book offers a comprehensive treatment of core concepts, grounded in both classic studies and current and emerging research. The text also includes coverage of the DSM-5 in examinations of psychological disorders. *Psychology 2e* incorporates discussions that reflect the diversity within the discipline, as well as the diversity of cultures and communities across the globe.

Coverage and scope

The first edition of *Psychology* has been used by thousands of faculty and hundreds of thousands of students since its publication in 2015. OpenStax mined our adopters' extensive and helpful feedback to identify the most significant revision needs while maintaining the organization that many instructors had incorporated into their courses. Specific surveys, pre-revision reviews, and customization analysis, as well as analytical data from OpenStax partners and online learning environments, all aided in planning the revision.

The result is a book that thoroughly treats psychology's foundational concepts while adding current and meaningful coverage in specific areas. *Psychology 2e* retains its manageable scope and contains ample features to draw learners into the discipline.

Structurally, the textbook remains similar to the first edition, with no chapter reorganization and very targeted changes at the section level.

Chapter 1: Introduction to Psychology

Chapter 2: Psychological Research

Chapter 3: Biopsychology

Chapter 4: States of Consciousness

Chapter 5: Sensation and Perception

Chapter 6: Learning

Chapter 7: Thinking and Intelligence

Chapter 8: Memory

Chapter 9: Lifespan Development

Chapter 10: Motivation and Emotion

Chapter 11: Personality

Chapter 12: Social Psychology

Chapter 13: Industrial-Organizational Psychology

Changes to the Second Edition

OpenStax only undertakes second editions when significant modifications to the text are necessary. In the case of *Psychology 2e*, user feedback indicated that we needed to focus on a few key areas, which we have done in the following ways.

Content revisions for clarity, accuracy, and currency

The revision plan varied by chapter based on need. Some chapters were significantly updated for conceptual coverage, research-informed data, and clearer language. In other chapters, the revisions focused mostly on currency of examples and updates to statistics.

Over 210 new research references have been added or updated in order to improve the scholarly underpinnings of the material and broaden the perspective for students. Dozens of examples and feature boxes have been changed or added to better explain concepts and/or increase relevance for students.

Research replication and validity

To engage students in stronger critical analysis and inform them about research reproducibility, substantial coverage has been added to the research chapter and strategically throughout the textbook whenever key studies are discussed. This material is presented in a balanced way and provides instructors with ample opportunity to discuss the importance of replication in a manner that best suits their course.

Diversity, representation, and inclusion

With the help of researchers and teachers who focus on diversity- and identity-related issues, OpenStax has engaged in detailed diversity reviews to identify opportunities to improve the textbook. Reviewers were asked to follow a framework to evaluate the book's terminology, research citations, key contributors to the field, photos and illustrations, and related aspects, commenting on the representation and consideration of diverse groups. Significant additions and revisions were made in this regard, and the review framework itself is available among the OpenStax *Psychology 2e* instructor resources.

Art and illustrations

Under the guidance of the authors and expert scientific illustrators, especially those well versed in creating accessible art, the OpenStax team made changes throughout the art program in *Psychology 2e*.

Accessibility improvements

As with all OpenStax books, the first edition of *Psychology* was created with a focus on accessibility. We have emphasized and improved that approach in the second edition. Our goal is to ensure that all OpenStax websites and the web view versions of our learning materials follow accessible web design best practices, so that they will meet the W3C-WAI Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0 at Level AA and Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act. The WCAG 2.0 guidelines explain ways to make web content more accessible for people with disabilities and more user-friendly for everyone.

- To accommodate users of specific assistive technologies, all alternative text was reviewed and revised for comprehensiveness and clarity.
- All illustrations were revised to improve the color contrast, which is important for some visually impaired students.
- Overall, the OpenStax platform has been continually upgraded to improve accessibility.

To learn more about our commitment and progress, please view our [accessibility statement](#).

A transition guide will be available on openstax.org to highlight the specific chapter-level changes to the second edition.

Pedagogical foundation

Psychology 2e engages students through inquiry, self-reflection, and investigation. Features in the second edition have been carefully updated to remain topical and relevant while deepening students' relationship to the material. They include the following:

Everyday Connection features tie psychological topics to everyday issues and behaviors that students encounter in their lives and the world. Topics include the validity of scores on college entrance exams, the opioid crisis, the impact of social status on stress and healthcare, and cognitive mapping.

What Do You Think? features provide research-based information and ask students their views on controversial issues. Topics include "Brain Dead and on Life Support," "Violent Media and Aggression," and "Capital Punishment and Criminals with Intellectual Disabilities."

Dig Deeper features discuss one specific aspect of a topic in greater depth so students can dig more deeply into the concept. Examples include discussions on the distinction between evolutionary psychology and behavioral genetics, recent findings on neuroplasticity, the field of forensic psychology, and a presentation of research on strategies for coping with prejudice and discrimination.

Connect the Concepts features revisit a concept learned in another chapter, expanding upon it within a different context. Features include "Emotional Expression and Emotional Regulation," "Tweens, Teens, and Social Norms," and "Conditioning and OCD."

Art, interactives, and assessments that engage

Our art program is designed to enhance students' understanding of psychological concepts through simple, effective graphs, diagrams, and photographs. *Psychology 2e* also incorporates links to relevant interactive exercises and animations that help bring topics to life. Selected assessment items touch directly on students' lives.

Link to Learning features direct students to online interactive exercises and animations that add a fuller context to core content and provide an opportunity for application.

Personal Application Questions engage students in topics at a personal level to encourage reflection and promote discussion.

Answers to Questions in the Book

Answers to Review Questions and Critical Thinking Questions are provided in the Instructor Solution Guide. Select answers to Review Questions and Critical Thinking Questions are provided in the Student Solution Guide. Answers to Personal Application Questions are not provided because answers will be highly variable among students.

Additional Resources

Student and Instructor Resources

We've compiled additional resources for both students and instructors, including Getting Started Guides, an instructor solution guide, a test bank, and PowerPoint slides. Instructor resources require a verified instructor account, which you can apply for when you log in or create your account on openstax.org. Take advantage of these resources to supplement your OpenStax book.

Community Hubs

OpenStax partners with the Institute for the Study of Knowledge Management in Education (ISKME) to offer Community Hubs on OER Commons—a platform for instructors to share community-created resources that support OpenStax books, free of charge. Through our Community Hubs, instructors can upload their own materials or download resources to use in their own courses, including additional ancillaries, teaching material, multimedia, and relevant course content. We encourage instructors to join the hubs for the subjects most relevant to your teaching and research as an opportunity both to enrich your courses and to engage with other faculty.

To reach the Community Hubs, visit www.oercommons.org/hubs/openstax.

Technology partners

As allies in making high-quality learning materials accessible, our technology partners offer optional low-cost tools that are integrated with OpenStax books. To access the technology options for your text, visit your book page on openstax.org.

About the authors

Senior contributing authors

Rose M. Spielman (Content Lead)

Dr. Rose Spielman has been teaching psychology and working as a licensed clinical psychologist for 20 years. Her academic career has included positions at Quinnipiac University, Housatonic Community College, and Goodwin College. As a licensed clinical psychologist, educator, and volunteer director, Rose is able to connect with people from diverse backgrounds and facilitate treatment, advocacy, and education. In her years of work as a teacher, therapist, and administrator, she has helped thousands of students and clients and taught them to advocate for themselves and move their lives forward to become more productive citizens and family members.

William J. Jenkins, Mercer University

Marilyn D. Lovett, Spelman College

Contributing Authors

Mara Aruguete, Lincoln University

Laura Bryant, Eastern Gateway Community College

Barbara Chappell, Walden University

Kathryn Dumper, Bainbridge State College

Arlene Lacombe, Saint Joseph's University

Julie Lazzara, Paradise Valley Community College

Tammy McClain, West Liberty University

Barbara B. Oswald, Miami University

Marion Perlmutter, University of Michigan

Mark D. Thomas, Albany State University

Reviewers

Patricia G. Adams, Pitt Community College

Daniel Bellack, Trident Technical College

Christopher M. Bloom, Providence College

Jeremy Blowers, Cayuga Community College

Salena Brody, Collin College

David A. Caicedo, Borough of Manhattan Community College, CUNY

Bettina Casad, University of Missouri–St. Louis

Sharon Chacon, Northeast Wisconsin Technical College

James Corpening

Frank Eyetsemitan, Roger Williams University

Tamara Ferguson, Utah State University

Kathleen Flannery, Saint Anselm College

Johnathan Forbey, Ball State University

Laura Gaudet, Chadron State College

William Goggin, University of Southern Mississippi

Jeffery K. Gray, Charleston Southern University

Heather Griffiths, Fayetteville State University

Mark Holder, University of British Columbia

Rita Houge, Des Moines Area Community College

Colette Jacquot, Strayer University

John Johanson, Winona State University

Andrew Johnson, Park University

Shailla Khan, Tougaloo College

Cynthia Kreutzer, Georgia State University Perimeter College at Clarkston Campus

Carol Laman, Houston Community College

Dana C. Leighton, Texas A&M University—Texarkana

Thomas Malloy, Rhode Island College

Jan Mendoza, Golden West College

Christopher Miller, University of Minnesota

Lisa Moeller, Beckfield College

Amy T. Nusbaum, Heritage University

Jody Resko, Queensborough Community College (CUNY)

Hugh Riley, Baylor University

Juan Salinas, University of Texas at Austin

Brittney Schrick, Southern Arkansas University

Phoebe Scotland, College of the Rockies

Christine Selby, Husson University

Sally B. Seraphin, Centre College
Brian Sexton, Kean University
Nancy Simpson, Trident Technical College
Jason M. Smith, Federal Bureau of Prisons – FCC Hazelton
Robert Stennett, University of Georgia
Jennifer Stevenson, Ursinus College
Eric Weiser, Curry College
Jay L. Wenger, Harrisburg Area Community College
Alan Whitehead, Southern Virginia University
Valjean Whitlow, American Public University
Rachel Wu, University of California, Riverside
Alexandra Zelin, University of Tennessee at Chattanooga

[Next >](#)



Earn badges by participating in research
and discover more insights about yourself!



[Explore Kinetic](#)

[Order a print copy](#)

[▶ Citation/Attribution](#)

**OpenStax's mission is
to make an amazing
education accessible
for all.**

OpenStax is part of Rice
University, which is a 501(c)(3)
nonprofit. [Give today](#) and help
us reach more students.

Help

[Contact Us](#)
[Support Center](#)
[FAQ](#)
[System Status](#)
[Keyboard Shortcuts](#)

OpenStax

[Press](#)
[Newsletter](#)
[Careers](#)

Policies

[Accessibility Statement](#)
[Terms of Use](#)
[Licensing](#)
[Privacy Policy](#)
[Manage Cookies](#)

© 1999–2026, Rice University. Except where otherwise noted, textbooks on this site are licensed under a [Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 \(CC BY NC-SA\) license](#).

Advanced Placement[®] and AP[®] are trademarks registered and/or owned by the College Board, which is not affiliated with, and does not endorse, this site.

